ENG519 Glossary

- **Assessment :**The process through which the progress and achievements of a learner or learners is measured or judged in compliance with specific quality criteria.
- **Attained curriculum :**Curriculum which indicates the knowledge, understanding, skills and attitudes that learners actually acquire as a result of teaching and learning, assessed through different means and/or demonstrated in practice. It may differ from the intended and the implemented curriculum.
- **Backward :**In a reverse or contrary direction or way
- **Basic Learning Needs :**Needs which comprise both essential learning tools (such as literacy, oral expression, numeracy, and problem solving) and the basic learning content (such as knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes) required by human beings to be able to survive, to develop their full capacities, to live and work in dignity, to participate fully in development, to improve the quality of their lives, to make informed decisions, and to continue learning.
- **Bilingual Education :**A language policy in education under which two languages are used as mediums of instruction.
- **Case Study :**A process or record of research into the development of a particular person, group, or situation over a period of time is known as case study.
- **Classification :**The action or process of classifying something
- **Classroom-Based Assessment (CBA) :**Assessment carried out by teachers based on the learning that has taken place within the context of a classroom. It offers feedback to teachers and students on the quality of the learning performance supporting its ongoing improvement. Also referred to as 'classroom assessment' and 'teacher-based assessment'.
- **Competence :**Competence is defined as a combination of knowledge, skills and attitudes appropriate to the context. Competence indicates the ability to apply learning outcomes adequately in a defined context (education, work, personal or professional development). Competence is not limited to cognitive elements (involving the use of theory, concepts or tacit knowledge); it also encompasses functional aspects (involving technical skills) as well as interpersonal attributes.
- **Competency :**The quality of being competent or capable of performing an allotted function
- **Competency-Based Curriculum :**A curriculum that emphasizes the complex outcomes of a learning process (i.e. knowledge, skills and attitudes to be applied by learners) rather than mainly focusing on what learners are expected to learn traditionally-defined subject content. In principle such a curriculum is learner-centered and adaptive to the changing needs of students.

- **Concept-based curriculum :**A concept-based curriculum uses concepts to define standards of knowledge and skills associated with a given area of learning. It is focused on the key concepts, principles, and generalizations that are used to organize knowledge and solve problems within and across disciplines.
- **Constraints :**The state of being checked, restricted, or compelled to avoid or perform some action.
- **Constructivism :**A theory that learning is an active process and that people gain knowledge and understanding through the combination of experiences and ideas: The student actively builds knowledge and skill in a learning process called constructivism.
- **Content :**Content area refers to a defined domain of knowledge and skill in an academic program.
- **Core curriculum :**The body of knowledge, skills and attitudes expected to be learned by all students, generally related to a set of subjects and learning areas that are common to all students.
- **Cross-curricular approach :**An approach to formulating curriculum that favors the dynamic use of learning topics and themes to be covered and skills/competencies to be developed in a number of learning areas across the curriculum.
- **Culturally responsive curriculum :**A curriculum that respects learners' cultures and prior experiences. It acknowledges and values the legitimacy of different cultures, not just the dominant culture of a society, and encourages intercultural 16 understanding. It incorporates cultural aspects into the curriculum, rather than adding them on as an extra or separate module or course.
- **Curriculum :**The subjects comprising a course of study in a school or college
- **Curriculum (plural curricula) :**In the simplest terms, 'curriculum' is a description of what, why, how and how well students should learn in a systematic and intentional way. The curriculum is not an end in itself but rather a means to fostering quality learning. The term curriculum has many definitions, ranging from a planned 'course of study' (derived from the Latin) to an all-embracing view that includes all the learning experiences for which the school is responsible (e.g. "the curriculum is the totality of experiences which are planned for children and young people through their education, wherever they are being educated".
- **Curriculum adaptation :**A process of adjusting the existing curriculum to meet the diverse needs of learners of all abilities.
- **Curriculum aims/goals :**Curriculum aims or goals relate to educational aims and philosophy. They are programmatic and normally do not delineate the specific courses or specific items of content. Typically they refer to the accomplishment of groups (e.g. all learners) rather than the achievement of individual learners. They are broad enough to lead to specific curriculum objectives.

- **Curriculum design :**The process of meaningfully constructing and interconnecting the components of a curriculum so as to address such fundamental questions as what needs to be learned and how and why, the resources required and how learning will be assessed.
- **Curriculum development :**The process of designing the national, local or school curriculum. In order to produce a quality curriculum, this process is planned and systematic.
- **Curriculum evaluation :**The process of measuring and judging the extent to which the planned courses, programs, learning activities and opportunities as expressed in the formal curriculum actually produce the expected results. If carried out effectively, this process can enable decisions to be made about improvements and future progress.
- **Curriculum guidelines :**A document or set of documents usually providing guidance for teachers and instructors on approaches and procedures for a successful planning and implementation of the curriculum at school, local or 19 national level. Guidelines can focus on a specific learning area or a particular educational level.
- **Curriculum integration :**The process of combining/articulating learning content and subjects with a view to promoting holistic and comprehensive learning.
- **Curriculum models :**Broad theoretical frameworks used to design and organize the curriculum according to certain principles and criteria.
- **Curriculum objectives :**Specific statements setting measurable expectations for what learners should know and be able to do, describe either in terms of learning outcomes, products and performance or processes. They can be seen as refinements of curriculum aims/goals.
- **Decisions :**A conclusion or resolution reached after consideration
- **Epistemological :**It is the study or a theory of the nature and grounds of knowledge especially with reference to its limits and validity
- **Evaluation :**To judge or determine the significance, worth, or quality of; assess: to evaluate the results of an experiment
- **Exemplification :**The act of exemplifying
- **External assessment :**A process and method of assessment developed and used by an examination body or agency other than the learner's school. This process commonly involves standardized testing, and often serves to grade candidates for further educational opportunities and/or for certification purposes.
- **Extrinsic :**Not part of the essential nature of someone or something; coming or operating from outside.
- **Feedback :**Helpful information or criticism that is given to someone to say what can be done to improve a performance, product, etc.
- **Format :**The way in which something is arranged or set out
- **Formative assessment :**Assessment conducted throughout the educational process with a view to enhancing student learning. It implies: eliciting evidence about learning to close

the gap between current and desired performance, providing feedback to students; and involving students in the assessment and learning process.

- **Functional syllabus :**Syllabus based on communicative acts such as making introductions, making requests, expressing opinions, requesting information, refusing, apologizing, giving advice, persuading; this type of syllabus is often used in communicative language teaching.
- **Goals :**The object of a person's ambition or effort; an aim or desired result
- **Impetus :**Stimulation or encouragement resulting in increased activity
- **Inclusive curriculum :**Curriculum which takes into consideration and caters for the diverse needs, previous experiences, interests and personal characteristics of all learners
- **Indicators :**A thing that indicates the state or level of something
- **Innovative :**Introducing new ideas; original and creative in thinking
- **Input :**What is put in, taken in, or operated on by any process or system
- **Intrinsic :**Belonging to the essential nature or constitution of a thing
- **Language learning requirements :**To learn language, students have four needs: They must be exposed to the language. They must understand its meaning and structure. And they must practice it. Teachers should hold their students as able. They should not over-explain or make things too easy.
- **Learner centeredness :**An approach to organizing teaching, learning and assessment based on the learner's personal characteristics, needs and interests.
- **Learning environments :**A learning environment is the combined social, physical, psychological, relational, and pedagogical contexts within which learning takes place.
- **Learning objectives :**Specification of learning to be achieved upon completion of an educational program or an activity. Learning objectives can also be specified for a lesson, a theme, a year, or an entire course.
- **Learning outcomes :**The totality of information, knowledge, understanding, attitudes, values, skills, competencies or behaviors a learner has mastered upon the successful completion of an education program.
- **Learning standards :**A learning standard is an explicit statement of what students are expected know, understand, and be able to do in a given grade and area of learning
- **Learning styles :**A set of behaviors and attitudes that influence how students learn and interact with teachers and peers. Learning styles are cognitive, effective, and physiological behaviors that serve as indicators of how learners perceive, interact with, and respond to the learning environment
- **Lesson plan :** An outline of a topic to be addressed in a given period which can take a variety of forms and be prepared on a daily, weekly or monthly basis. It normally involves defining specific learning objectives aligned with the existing curriculum, selection of subject matter, required materials and resources, the activities that will take place as well as time and class management notes, assessment methods, and the links between previous and following lessons.

- **Medium :** Means of effecting or conveying something. Means by which something is communicated or expressed
- **Monitoring :** Observe and check the progress or quality of (something) over a period of time; keep under systematic review.
- **Motivation :**The act or process of giving someone a reason for doing something: the act or process of motivating someone.
- **National curriculum :**A description – normally set out in a document or series of related documents – of the prescribed common goals, objectives and quality and/or content criteria of a national school system. This may take the form of standards (defined objectives and achievement criteria at given levels of education and in specific subjects or learning areas). It may also indicate the extent to which decisions on curriculum content can be made on the local or school level.
- **Native speakers :**Those who speak the language in question as their mother tongue.
- **Need Analysis :**Needs analysis is defined as a formal process focus on how a product addresses the needs of a human.
- **Opportunistic :**Exploiting immediate opportunities, especially regardless of planning or principle
- **Organizing :**Make arrangements or preparations for (an event or activity)
- **Outcomes-based education :**An approach to schooling that makes outcomes (intended results) the key factor in planning and creating educational experiences. In the 1990s this approach was controversial in the USA and now the term is not frequently used. Outcomes-based education and curricula became popular in other parts of the world as well. However, this approach is increasingly controversial especially when outcomes such as competences/c
- **Output :**The action or process of producing something
- **Presentation :**A speech or talk in which a new product, idea, or piece of work is shown and explained to an audience
- **Problem-based learning :**A process designed to experimentally engage learners in processes of inquiry into complex problems of significance and relevance to their lives and learning. It is intended to challenge learners to pursue authentic questions, wonders, and uncertainties in a focused way, which enables them to construct, deepen, and extend their knowledge and understanding.
- **Procedures :**A series of actions conducted in a certain order or manner.
- **Project-based learning :**A process that fosters learners' engagement in studying authentic problems or issues centered on a particular project, theme, or idea. Often the term 'project-based' is used interchangeably with 'problem based', especially when classroom projects focus on solving authentic problems.
- **Psychomotor :**Relating to the origination of movement in conscious mental activity
- **Reinforced :**To strengthen by adding more material for support

- **School-based curriculum development :**Curriculum developed at the level of an individual school. This notion suggests a decision-making process with regard to the curriculum involving school staff, ranging from individual teachers adapting existing curricula to the whole school staff collaboratively working together to develop new curricula in order to make them more relevant and meaningful for learners.
- **Scope and sequence (in curriculum): :**Interrelated concepts that refer to the overall organization of the curriculum in order to ensure its coherence and continuity. Scope refers to the breadth and depth of content and skills to be covered. Sequence refers to how these skills and content are ordered and presented to learners over time.
- **Sequencing :**An arrangement of two or more things in a successive order
- **Situation analysis :**Situation analysis is an analysis of factors in the context of a planned or present curriculum project that is made in order to assess their potential impact on the project. Situation analysis complements the information gathered during needs analysis
- **Spiral curriculum :**Curriculum design in which key concepts and topics are repeatedly presented over time in the context of new, broader and more complex learning experiences. It serves for consolidating pre existent learning as well as broadening and exploring more in-depth the different learning content.
- **Standards-based curriculum :**A curriculum directed toward mastery of predetermined standards. Content standards refer to what learners are expected to know and be able to do in various subject areas. Performance standards specify what levels of learning are expected and assess the degree to which content standards have been met.
- **Syllabus :**An outline or other brief statement of the main points of a discourse, the subjects of a course of lectures, the contents of a curriculum.
- **Syllabus (plural syllabi or syllabuses) :**A document which outlines the aims, selection and sequence of contents to be covered, mode of delivery, materials to be used, learning tasks and activities, expected learning objectives or outcomes, and assessment/evaluation schemes of a specific course, unit of study or teaching subject. It is often used incorrectly as an equivalent of the term ‘curriculum’.
- **Task analysis :**Task analysis is the process of learning about ordinary users by observing them in action to understand in detail how they perform their tasks and achieve their intended goals.
- **Task-based syllabus :**A syllabus organized around a sect of real, purposeful tasks that students are expected to carry out; tasks may include telephone use, making charts or maps, following instructions, and so on; task-based learning is purposeful and a natural way to learn language.
- **Teachability :**Capable of being taught
- **Test :**An examination or assessment exercise designed to measure the learner’s acquired knowledge and skills. Tests may be set and marked by the teacher or by an external agency.

- **Testing :**Take measures to check the quality, performance, or reliability of (something), especially before putting it into widespread use or practice
- **Textbook :**A written source of information, designed specifically for the use of students, on a particular subject or field of study that is usually developed based on a syllabus and geared towards meeting specific quality and learning requirements. School textbooks pertain to an instructional sequence based on an organized curriculum.
- **Traditional :**Following or belonging to the customs or ways of behaving that have continued in a group of people or society for a long time without changing
- **Upsurge :**An upsurge is when there's a sudden rise of something's strength or size.
- **Vocabulary-based syllabus :**Syllabus built around vocabulary; often associated with the grammatical syllabus and the grammar translation method.

ENG520 Glossary

- **Assessment :**Assessment refers to the wide variety of methods or tools that educators use to evaluate, measure, and document the academic readiness, learning progress, skill acquisition, or educational needs of students.
- **Benchmark :**An expected performance level for a student at a particular point in time determined by standards based criteria; an identified content standard for a particular course, grade level, or developmental level at a specific point in time
- **Constructed Response Questions :**Assessment item for which students create or produce their own answer or response. Examples of constructed-response questions include short answer questions and extended written response/essay questions.
- **Formative Assessment :**Formative assessments are assessments for learning. They are designed to provide information needed to adjust teaching and learning while they are happening. These assessments are used by teachers and students to determine what students have learned in order to plan further instruction
- **High Stake Assessment :**High-stakes assessments are typically standardized tests used for the purposes of accountability—i.e., any attempt by federal, state, or local government agencies to ensure that students are enrolled in effective schools and being taught by effective teachers.
- **Learning objective :**A learning objective is a specific statement that describes what the student is to learn, understand, or to be able to do as a result of a lesson or a series of lessons.
- **Measurement :**Measurement is simply the process of assigning a number, or a score if you will, to some performance or product. Examples would include grading a test or a homework assignment in terms of number or percent of correct or incorrect responses

- **Multiple Choice Questions :**A task-type in which learners are given a question and three or four possible answers or options. They choose the correct answer from the options they are given.
- **Norm Referenced Test :**Assessments that compare a student's performance to that of other students rather than to previously established criteria. Standardized examinations such as the SAT are norm-referenced tests
- **Performance Assessment :**Performance assessments are designed to measure what students know through their ability to perform certain tasks. In certain situations, performance assessments – sometimes called performance-based assessments – may provide a more accurate indication of what students can do than traditional assessments are able to provide. Performance-based assessments typically include exhibitions, investigations, creation of products, demonstrations, written or oral responses, journals, and portfolios.
- **Pre-Assessment :**Assessments that gather and analyze baseline data about what students know and can do as they enter the learning experience.
- **Reliability :**Reliability refers to the degree of consistency or dependability of a test. A reliable test will produce similar scores and distributions whenever it is given to similar populations. Thus, if a student scored a 90 on an achievement test today, then, if the test is reliable, the student's score would not differ substantially if the test were taken again another day. Reliability may also mean that a student would earn similar scores on two different forms of a test, if tested at about the same time.
- **Selected Response Question :**Assessment item for which students select a response from possible responses that are provided. Examples of selected-response questions include multiple-choice, true/false, and matching
- **Summative Assessment :**Summative assessments are assessments of learning. They are designed to document what students have learned at the end of a period of instruction relative to the standards.
- **Validity :**Validity is a term that describes how well a test, or a test item, measures what it claims to measure, accurately predicts a behavior, or accurately contributes to decision making about the presence or absence of a characteristic.